

FlyDubai suspends flights to and from Israel after pilot stabbing

送信者: POLITICO Pro Mobility 受信日時: 2026-10-01 13:03

[【メール原文】](#)

FlyDubai Airlines has suspended all its flights to and from Israel after one pilot stabbed another on a flight to Tel Aviv, causing the plane to plumm

Pro is better in the app.

[Click here to download.](#)

FlyDubai suspends flights to and from Israel after pilot stabbing

By Ashley Ahn · Oct 1, 2026, 1:27 AM · [View in your browser](#)

FlyDubai Airlines has suspended all its flights to and from Israel after one pilot stabbed another on a flight to Tel Aviv, causing the plane to plummet thousands of feet.

The Emirati flight made an emergency landing Wednesday in Tabuk, Saudi Arabia, after crew and passengers entered the cockpit and overpowered the co-pilot, according to Israeli officials . A second pair of FlyDubai pilots were on board and able to land the plane, according to FlyDubai and Reuters .

All passengers arrived safely in Tel Aviv by Wednesday night after FlyDubai sent replacement aircrafts to Tabuk.

“This temporary suspension will allow the relevant authorities to continue their work and establish all the facts surrounding the incident,” said FlyDubai , one of the largest flight operators in the Middle East.

Flight FZ 1073 departed Dubai on Wednesday morning local time en route to Tel Aviv, an approximately four-hour trip. Approximately two hours into the flight, the plane made a steep descent, followed by a sharp ascent and another descent, according to Flightradar24 , a flight tracking service. The plane plunged more than 15,000 feet in a span of two minutes, according to the radar.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said in a video statement that the assailant “apparently attempted to crash the plane with its passengers on board.” Nearly all the passengers on the flight were Israeli, he said.

On social media , Netanyahu called the injured co-pilot, identified as Capt. Smit Machchhar, a “true hero” for opening the cockpit door and enabling passengers and crew to jump the assailant and secure the plane. The Indian embassy in Saudi Arabia said on X that Machchhar was hospitalized there in stable condition.

President Donald Trump told reporters Wednesday that he spoke with Netanyahu about the attack and said the assailant appeared to be either “a terrorist or perhaps a whack job.”

Much of the details of the incident remain unclear as authorities investigate its cause.

The United Arab Emirates has had diplomatic relations with Israel since 2020, and the UAE government reportedly tried to warn Israel of a pending Hamas attack on Oct. 7, 2023. During the weekend, Netanyahu traveled to the UAE for discussions.

Mobility

Middle East Radar Services Social Media Benjamin Netanyahu Donald Trump X Dubai Israel Saudi Arabia
United Arab Emirates

This email alert has been sent for your exclusive use as a POLITICO Pro subscriber. Forwarding or reproducing the alert without the express, written permission of POLITICO Pro is a violation of the POLITICO Pro license agreement.

This email was sent to shondo@iies.co.jp

[Update settings](#) | [Unsubscribe from this email](#) | [Unsubscribe from all emails](#)

POLITICO SRL · Rue de la Loi 62 · Brussels 1040 · Belgium